



THE ARCTIC & ANTARCTICA

The Inuit, Saami, Aleut, and other indigenous people live in the icy lands of the Arctic North. For many generations, they have found ways of coping with their cold surroundings. But no one has settled for very long on the southern extremes of the planet. Antarctica is the coldest and windiest place in the world. This huge continent is lashed by freezing blizzards and gales, with temperatures almost as low as -148°F (-100°C).



Long-lost relatives

For many years, Inuit families on either side of the Bering Strait were not allowed to meet, for political reasons. Nowadays, the North American Inuit and their relatives in northern Asia can visit each other once again.

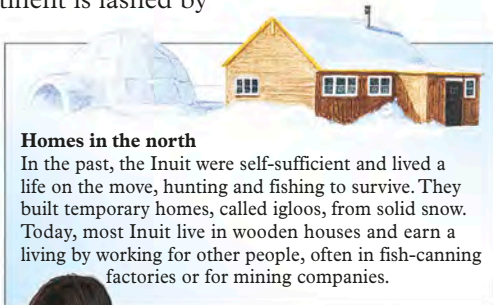


The Arctic



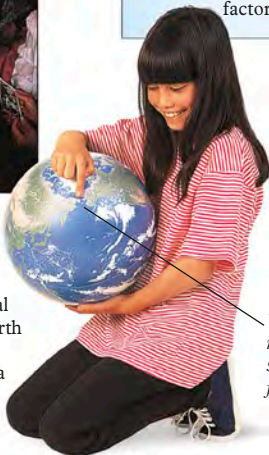
Icy city

Norilsk in the Arctic Circle is the farthest north city in the world. The sun does not rise in this Russian city between November and the middle of January.



Homes in the north

In the past, the Inuit were self-sufficient and lived a life on the move, hunting and fishing to survive. They built temporary homes, called igloos, from solid snow. Today, most Inuit live in wooden houses and earn a living by working for other people, often in fish-canning factories or for mining companies.



Speedy Ski-dogs

Today, the Inuit people get around on snowmobiles called Ski-dogs. This is much faster than using dogs to pull a sled, which is the traditional method of travel.

Warm clothes are vital in the Arctic.

The Bering Strait is a narrow stretch of sea that separates northern Asia from North America.

